

Shades By Niko: what their public marketing signals are actually saying

A short, evidence-based read of what's publicly visible — not internal data I don't have access to.

How this was built: every point below is checkable by anyone, using shadesbyniko.com's own live shop and About pages. Nothing here claims insight into revenue, order volume, or internal reporting.

1. A UK message on the EU version of the site

- Visiting the EU region of the store shows a running banner: "Free UK shipping on orders over €50,00" — a UK-specific offer, in Euros, on the page a non-UK visitor is actually looking at.
- The same line repeats identically around two dozen times in a row at the top of the page, on every page checked — consistent with a ticker banner that isn't looping correctly.

2. The About page is one sentence

- The entire "About us" copy reads: "After retiring from the political world, I've decided to focus on something more serious: sweets. Join us on our journey to being the biggest sweets company in the world."
- It's a genuinely funny line. It's also the only thing a new visitor gets — nothing about who Niko actually is, what's in a pack, or why to trust a first purchase.

3. A meaningful share of the shop is unavailable

- On the main shop page, several packs — including the "Ultimate Vibes Pack" and "It's Just Strawberries Pack" — show as Sold Out, directly in the primary browsing view.
- No restock date or "notify me" option is visible on the listing itself, so a visitor who wants exactly that pack has no obvious next step besides checking back manually.

4. Product names assume you're already a fan

- Names like "The Beta Five," "The OG'S Pack," and "Recruit Pack" read as community in-jokes — which works well for an existing audience, but the shop grid gives no visible description of flavour or contents for someone arriving without that context.
- Real community strength is visible elsewhere — Instagram, TikTok, YouTube and a WhatsApp channel are all linked directly from the site.

What this pattern usually means: this reads like a brand whose energy has gone almost entirely into the community it already has — content, drops, in-jokes, a real following across four platforms — and very little into the experience of someone who isn't part of that yet. That's a completely normal place for a young, creator-led brand to be. The fix is smaller than it looks: the shop and About page just need to do a little more of the explaining the community already does for free.

What I'd check first, in order

- 1 Fix the shipping banner for non-UK visitors.** A repeating, region-mismatched

message is one of the first things any new visitor sees — worth a five-minute check in the theme settings.

- 2 Add one paragraph to the About page for people who aren't already fans.**

Keep the joke — just add what's actually in a pack and why someone should try one first.

- 3 Add a "notify me" option to sold-out packs.** A visitor who wants the exact pack

that's unavailable is close to the easiest sale the brand will ever make — right now that demand has nowhere to go.



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